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VOL. 13 · ST. PATRICK EAST

From 121 Votes: Two New Faces in St. Patrick East

St. Patrick East was the NDC's narrowest win in 2022 after St. John, decided by 121 votes. In 2026 both parties changed candidates. The NDC's newcomer grew the party's vote while the NNP's fell by 280, and the margin widened to 687.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. PATRICK EAST, GRENADA

ST. PATRICK EAST, GRENADA—St. Patrick East, covering River Sallee, Hermitage, Mount Rose, Morne Fendue and St. Ann's, was one of the closest contests of 2022. The NDC's Dennis Matthew-Cornwall defeated the NNP's Pamela Moses by 1,443 votes to 1,322, a margin of 121.

> **"A new candidate with no time to become known is exposed to the full national swing."**
> GREG HOSTEN

In 2026 neither was on the ballot: the NDC ran Carl Andall and the NNP ran Robert Whyte. Mr. Andall won by 1,729 votes to 1,042, with 68 for the DPM's Dishon Edwards, and the margin rose to 687.

A FAIR TEST OF NEW CANDIDATES

Seats in which both main parties change candidates are rare, and analytically useful. Neither side could rely on an incumbent's personal vote or a familiar name, so the result measures the parties, their organisation and the national mood more cleanly than almost anywhere else.

By that measure, the NDC's organisation won comfortably. Its new candidate added 286 votes to the 2022 total, while the NNP's new candidate lost 280. The NNP's share of the two-party vote fell from 47.8 per cent to 37.6 per cent, a drop of 10.2 points, almost exactly the national swing.

THE NATIONAL SWING, WITH NOTHING TO STOP IT

That near-perfect correspondence with the national figure is the central finding. Where the NNP had a known candidate, as in St. John and St. Andrew North East, its fall was smaller than the national swing; where the NDC had a long-serving incumbent, as in St. George South, the NNP's fall was larger. In St. Patrick East no such local factor was present, and the NNP simply absorbed the national blow. A 121-vote seat cannot withstand a ten-point swing, and without a local advantage of its own the NNP lost a winnable seat by a clear margin.

WHERE THE VOTES WERE

The NNP carried 2 of the 14 polling divisions: one at the River Sallee Government School, by 103 votes to 96, and one at St. Ann's Pre-Primary School, by 113 to 110. River Sallee was its best area overall, with 46.3 per cent of the two-party vote across four divisions, while St. Ann's gave it 43.3 per cent.

Elsewhere the NDC won clearly. The NNP took 26.4 per cent at the Mount Rose SDA School, 29.2 per cent at the St. Patrick's Anglican School, about 31 per cent at Hermitage and 33.8 per cent at Morne Fendue.

The DPM's 68 votes were concentrated at St. Ann's, where it took 24, and Morne Fendue, where it took 9. Even all of them together would not have closed a 687-vote gap.

TURNOUT AND THE REGISTER

The register grew by 541 names between 2022 and 2026, and 51 more ballots were cast, while turnout fell from 71.3 per cent to 63.8 per cent. Measured against the whole electorate, the NDC's share rose slightly, from 36.9 to 38.8 per cent of all registered voters, and the NNP's fell from 33.8 to 23.4 per cent.

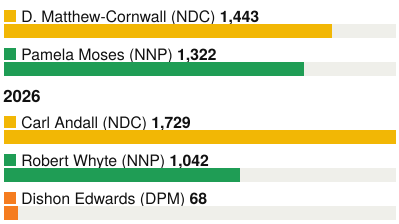
Once again the pattern holds: the NDC maintained and slightly enlarged its share of the electorate, while the NNP lost about a third of its support, much of it to abstention.

THREE HUNDRED AND FORTY-FOUR VOTERS

To win the seat back, the NNP needs 344 voters to switch sides, or 688 more of its own supporters to turn out, about two in five of

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



687 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

121 → 687
NDC margin in 2022 and in 2026, with new candidates on both sides

2 of 14
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–10.2 pts
Fall in the NNP's two-party share, matching the national swing

344
Switchers the NNP needed to win

those who stayed home. Recovering the 2022 vote of 1,322 alone would cut the margin by more than 40 per cent.

St. Patrick East was within reach four years ago and can be within reach again. Its history as the seat of former Prime Minister Tillman Thomas shows that it rewards long-term representation.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR ST. PATRICK EAST

St. Patrick East needs the NNP to create the local advantage it lacked in 2026.

Year one, 2027: name the candidate early and commit to that person for two elections. A new candidate in 2026 was simply exposed to the national swing; a candidate known for four years will not be. Open a permanent office in River Sallee, the largest polling site and the NNP's strongest.

Year two, 2028: build from River Sallee and St. Ann's, where the NNP won divisions, into Hermitage and Morne Fendue. Hold regular meetings with farmers, fishers, young people and families, and publish what they say.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 14 polling divisions, and hold the sitting member publicly to account for what St. Patrick has received from the government.

Year four, 2030: target 344 switchers, beginning with the 280 NNP voters lost since 2022.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

A new candidate with no time to become known is exposed to the full national swing. St. Patrick East shows precisely that: a 121-vote seat lost by 687 when nothing local stood in the way.

The best protection against a poor national year is a candidate whom voters already know, and the NNP has four years in which to give every target seat one.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. PATRICK EAST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,322	1,042	−280
NDC votes	1,443	1,729	+286
NNP share of two-party vote	47.8%	37.6%	−10.2 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +121	NDC +687	
Registered voters	3,914	4,455	+541
Turnout	71.3%	63.8%	−7.5 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,123	1,613	+490
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	33.8%	23.4%	−10.4 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		2 of 14	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		344	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2022: GULP 18; 2026: DPM 68). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office; the published division list contains a duplicated label, but its vote totals match the constituency count.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. A new candidate takes the full national swing: give them time.
2. Name the candidate in 2027 and keep them for two elections.
3. Open a permanent office in River Sallee, the NNP's best area.
4. Build from River Sallee and St. Ann's into Hermitage and Morne Fendue.
5. Win back the 280 NNP voters lost since 2022.
6. Captain all 14 divisions.
7. Hold the sitting member to account on what St. Patrick received.
8. Target 344 switchers.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2008 and 2022 general elections); NOW Grenada (2022 nominations; 2026 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 13 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.